

DOWNTOWN

Sunday
March 22, 2026

THE HINDU

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarethpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair
Avadi » Ayyapakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills



35 JSP GROUP

BUY BEFORE PRICE HIKE

PRICE HIKE ALERT

FROM APRIL 1ST 2026

BOOK NOW & SAVE UPTO ₹5,000*

CB350C

₹

LOW DOWN PAYMENT ₹9999

LOW RATE OF INTEREST 6.49%

CSD SALES AVAILABLE

POLICE CANTEEN SALES AVAILABLE

10 YEARS WARRANTY
3 YEARS + 7 EXTENDED YEARS

Honda BigWing Anna Nagar
3rd Ave P Block, Anna Nagar, Chennai,
☎ 8056019461

Honda BigWing Chennai North
L44, Ambattur Industrial Estate, Chennai.
☎ 8056030574

Honda BigWing
EXCITES THE WORLD—

CORPORATE OFFER UPTO ₹5000*

EXCHANGE BONUS ₹2000*

CREDIT CARD CASHBACK ₹5000*

CSD SALES AVAILABLE

KPKB SALES AVAILABLE

March MEGA Clearance Sale

LOW DOWN PAYMENT ₹2,999*

Scooter ACTIVA

BUY BEFORE PRICE HIKE

BEFORE MAR 31ST 2026

35 JSP GROUP

ANNA NAGAR 9841648574	AMBATTUR 9841644333	AMBATTUR PUDUR 9841648579	ARUMBAKKAM 8144841707	AMINJIKARAI 9087005605
CHOO LAI 7299111005	MUGAPPAIR 9841648546	KPN AUTOMMOTIVE 9841648544	PADI 9841648513	PERAMBUR 9841810779

RIGHT PLACE. RIGHT PRICE.
JSP Honda Authorised Main Dealer

‘Safety measure lacking at SWD work site’



D. RADHAKRISHNAN

The image, taken on March 17, 2026, shows a pit on Medawakkam Tank Road in Kilpauk, adjacent to TNSC Bank, Kelly's branch. A few more pits of this kind are found there.

These pits are dug up by the Greater Chennai Corporation on

account of the stormwater drain construction that is under way.

But there are no safety measures such as barricades or signboards to caution the public. This has been the status for more than a week. And this makes it unsafe especially for senior citizens.

D. Radhakrishnan is a resident of Kilpauk

Chaos reigns at Secretariat Colony

STEPHEN DIQUE

The ongoing stormwater drain construction, carried out by the Greater Chennai Corporation, at Secretariat Colony in Kellys is testing the patience of residents.

Sewage pipes of the Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply & Sewerage Board have been damaged resulting in sewage leakage into the stormwater drain which is under construction.

The water pipes have also been damaged resulting in sewage contamination.

Earlier, there were instances of power cables of Tamil Nadu Generation & Distribution Corporation Limited and power cables in street lights installed by GCC being damaged causing disruption in power supply.

All these show poor coordination and planning among the de-



Secretariat Colony First Street near the intersection of A K Swamy Ninth Street. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

partments concerned.

When complaints were raised, each department was blaming the other with no solution in sight. Work is under way at around 20 streets in the neighbourhood and we learnt contracts have been awarded to different contractors. In my view, this is among the major reasons for the chaos.

There is no coordination among the contractors while they are blocking the roads to carry out the work.

In some houses, entry and exit is difficult.

In short, the SWD work has led the entire neighbourhood into a state of dysfunction.

Stephen Dique is a resident of Secretariat Colony

New building for Ward 67 office inaugurated

A new building for the office of Ward 67 in Zone 6 - Thiru Vi Ka Nagar was inaugurated recently on Paper Mills Road in Sembium. It is located opposite Mir Sajjad Husain Park.

According to GCC officials, the new building will accommodate the offices of Ward 67 Assistant Engineer and elected representatives. Beside, property tax can be paid here. It will be an integrated facility.



The building on Paper Mills Road in Sembium.

S. KASTURI RANGAN

Nungambakkam crematorium sports a new look

Greater Chennai Corporation's crematorium on Nelson Manickam Road in Nungambakkam is looking sharp, having been imparted a new look by a massive makeover. With the redevelopment exercise spanning eight months having run its course, the facility was reopened a few weeks ago.

GCC officials point out the work was carried out at a cost of ₹1.5 crore allocated under Thousand Lights MLA Local Area Development Fund.

The work features a verdant landscape to the facility with sprawling lawns, trees, and flowering plants. The decades-old dilapidated buildings that housed the furnace and where the last rites were performed have been demolished and new ones with good ventilation have been constructed.

Paver block walkways lead to these buildings. Adequate number of benches and lights have

been provided. All these impart a serene and tranquil ambience to the crematorium.

Earlier, the place was unkempt and in a rundown state. Because, Greater Chennai Corporation was using the crematorium as a waste segregation point. The place used to stink. For many years, residents have been requesting GCC to refrain from using the crematorium for waste management purpose. Further the broken compound walls gave room for illegal activities. We are happy to note that the renovation work has put an end to all those issues.

Next, an additional gasifier has been provided as part of the rede-



velopment exercise. It may be noted this crematorium witnesses a good patronage. In addition to residents of Nungambakkam and Choolaimedu, those from Spur Tank Road in Egmore, North Usmaan Road - T Nagar, and Amnjikarai near Anna Nagar also use this



The crematorium on Nelson Manickam Road in Nungambakkam. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

crematorium.

So an additional facility was badly needed. This was a decade-long request of the local residents and that has been honoured now.

The crematorium falls in Ward 110 of Zone 9 - Teynampet.

S. Kasturi Rangan is the secretary of Choolaimedu Exnora Innovators Club, Choolaimedu

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarathpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair

Avadi » Ayyapakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills



A 'JAMMING' SESSION AHEAD OF TN ELECTIONS

A data jam on March 28 will have participants studying how the Assembly constituencies in and around Chennai are faring on a set of parameters **P2**



CALCUTTA, I'M SORRY WANTS TO BE ON OTT

Global Anglo-Indian Network (GAIN) has started a petition to help take Ayanavaram resident Harry MacLure's latest film to a global audience. **P3**

'Request for lifts at Annanur railway station remains unmet'

KARUNAKAR .K

Various railway stations in the Chennai Division of Southern Railway are undergoing redevelopment under Amrit Bharat Station Scheme. Sree Shakthi Nagar Residents Welfare Association in Annanur strongly believe that Annanur railway station was passed over unfairly, not being included in this exercise under the scheme.

Considering commuters' patronage of the station and the presence of EMU card shed complex, railway health centre and railway quarters, Annanur railway station should have been a beneficiary of the scheme. But it is not.

At least, lifts should be provided at the station's foot overbridge. From time to time, the Association has



Annanur railway station.

been requesting Southern Railway to provide this facility and it also made a representation a year ago. But our efforts have been in vain.

In the absence of lifts, senior citizens, the differently-abled and expectant mothers find it difficult to access the facility; the staircase is steep. Most of the commuters avoid the foot overbridge and take the risk of crossing the railway tracks.

The station also needs an additional ticket counter. The existing one is located on platform two, where suburban trains proceeding toward Chennai Central halt. Commuters who need to board EMU trains toward Avadi on platform one have to come to platform two to buy tickets and walk back to platform one. It is quite inconvenient. In the absence of the lift, commuters have to climb the staircase twice; a ticket counter on platform one is therefore necessary. Further, we request Southern Railway to relocate the existing ticket counter to the main entrance of the station.

Karunakar .K is the vice-president of Sree Shakthi Nagar Residents Welfare Association

Jawahar Nagar library reopened



The library on First Circular Street at Jawahar Nagar in Kolathur

After a year-long redevelopment work carried out by the Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority, the State Government-run public library in First Circular Street at Jawahar Nagar in Kolathur was reopened recently.

The decades-old building of the

library was demolished as it was prone to waterlogging and a new one has been constructed. Besides, Mudhalvar Padaippagam, a co-working space-cum-learning facility has been established at the library.

"Earlier, other than the library



members and long-time residents not many were aware of the library's existence. Now, the new building is quite prominent and swanky and a passer-by cannot miss it. The library has emerged as a landmark. Ergonomically designed chairs have been provided. Further, the new building is well ventilated," says a visitor to the library.

This library witnesses patronage from youngsters preparing for competitive examinations. Further, there is a dedicated section for children.

You can be our volunteer writer

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number



A data jam on March 28 will have participants studying how the Assembly constituencies in and around Chennai are faring on a set of parameters

LIFFY THOMAS

If data is a key factor for you to assess your constituency's performance then this event is for you. OpenCity, a civic tech platform that makes data easy to find, access, share and analyse is hosting a data jam on March 28 at Bhumi in Alwarpet to gauge how the city fared in parameters such as health, education, public transport, civic engagement and performance of the MLAs in the 20 Assembly constituencies in and around Chennai.

Data jam is not new to Chennai. OpenCity (a programme of the Oorvani Foundation) has in the past conducted similar workshops to study urban heat, lakes and flooding, and this one is planned to give participants a better understanding of the performance of the different constituencies ahead of the Assembly elections.

Here people from diverse professional backgrounds work in groups to understand how data can be used to understand civic issues plaguing the city.

Data available in the public domain is shared with participants and they analyse, brainstorm to get a better understanding of the issues and also give solutions.

For example, data from different databases and portals such as www.dge.tn.gov.in and UDISE will be used to get information on the number of government schools in an area, students enrolled and the count of teachers.

"Participants correlate to find what is lacking in every constituency," says Vaidya R., programme lead, Oorvani Foundation.

In 2024, the organisers used satellite data to understand ur-



A 'jamming' session ahead of TN elections

ban heat in different localities of Chennai. For instance, Koyamedu Metro was one of the hottest spots. In the part of Chennai it is located, Perungudi dumping ground topped the charts for extremely hot conditions.

The significance

"Either through maps put out by Greater Chennai Corporation or through their own experiences, participants correlated urban heat area," says Vaidya.

In some of the data jams, stakeholders take part in them or the findings are shared with them. The data jam on urban heat was presented to CMDA.

"A stakeholder could be a civic group working on the ground, and they could include the findings in petitions they submit to government departments," says Vaidya.

OpenCity has conducted data jams in all major metros and is happy these events offer people a platform to share their experiences. In Bangalore, a participant went on to develop a tool to measure the "public transport affinity" for a given area.

The data jam is being conducted in partnership with Citizen Consumer and Civic Action Group, Reach the Unreached and Nagariyal. For details, visit <https://forms.gle/cUIdseNvY-Yx4PWL78> or scan the QR code



'Data is a weapon'

Tambaram resident Raju K, working with a research agency, uses data to take up issues he feels strong about. In his mid-20s, Raju attended a data jam on lakes conducted by OpenCity; since then, he has been hugely curious about data jams.

A volunteer with Chennai Wetlands Action Collective and Save Madambakkam Lake Committee, Raju says OpenCity is a one-stop place to find data about a number of things.

For instance, for Save Madambakkam Lake Committee, they were able to get different data in the portal and use it in GIS maps and observe what the violations were.

"The data about the elevation of residential area, the lake and the real estate development next to the lake helped us get the real picture and petition various government authorities and seek action. We also found that as due to the difference in height, surface run-off water could not enter the lake and would inundate the existing residential area," he says.

Another example of using data is to analyse why certain areas get more inundated. "We studied 2015 inundation map and an earlier one to analyse Porur lake's catchment area. Urbanisation and SWDs not being interconnected were among reasons why inundation was common in this belt," he says.

Global Anglo-Indian Network (GAIN) has started a petition to help take Ayanavaram resident Harry MacLure's latest film to a global audience

LIFFY THOMAS

Chennai-based Harry MacLure, a well-known face of the Anglo-Indian community, is drumming up support for the release of his latest film *Calcutta, I'm Sorry* on OTT platforms.

Global Anglo-Indian Network (GAIN) has started a petition on Change.org asking people to support the campaign and showcase the talented, spirited people who have been part of the film.

Harry, who has scripted and directed the film, is a board member of GAIN. *Calcutta, I'm Sorry* is centred around Anglo-Indian characters, but is not a story about the Anglo-Indian community *per se* but brings out the essence of being Anglo-Indian. Featuring Priscilla Cor-



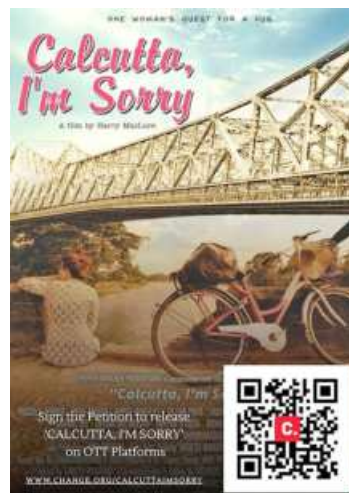
Calcutta, I'm Sorry wants to be on OTT

ner, who plays the protagonist Amanda Wright diagnosed with multiple sclerosis, the film takes viewers on an emotional road trip from Coonoor to Kolkata on a trusty bicycle to to meet her granddaughter.

The work on the movie began in

2019, but pandemic and other challenges delayed its theatrical release. In 2022, Harry and team completed the post production of the film that runs to one hour and 52 minutes.

"Usually a movie is released in theatres and then someone comes



forward to buy it and put it on an OTT platform, which did not happen in the case of this film," says Harry, who has started the petition to get more signatures so that it draws the attention of OTT platforms.

Besides showcasing the artistic talent of the Anglo-Indian community, the film has a powerful message from a lady with multiple sclerosis.

The petition reads, "This film beautifully captures the essence of our journey, moving through themes of family, search and redemption as it follows a determined woman's journey on a bicycle. It is a story of a woman's quest for a hug from a granddaughter she

The film takes viewers on an emotional road trip from Coonoor to Kolkata on a bicycle.

has never met, representing the deep emotional roots and resilience of our people."

By supporting this campaign, you are helping us amplify voices that have remained on the periphery for too long, the note adds.

Special screening

In the last few years, Harry has been screening the film for select groups. The Multiple Sclerosis Society of India, Chennai chapter, had a special screening of the film in 2024.

Recently, a Malayalam film distributor who liked the film said the movie would do well in Malayalam and wanted Harry to dub it.

"But I am hesitant, how can an Anglo-Indian story where we speak in English do well in Malayalam?" he wonders.

Filmmaking is not new to Harry who also is editor of *Anglos In The Wind*, a magazine for the community. In 2013, he directed *Going Away*, a film about the community's migration to foreign lands.

The petition adds: "Help us showcase the talented bunch we are and ensure the world truly knows us through our films."

Visit <https://c.org/CSwSdX7Djv>.

Teachers raise demands at meet

Members of School Voice -Tamil Nadu Private Schools Association want more private school teachers to be given Dr. Radhakrishnan Best Teachers Award



School Voice-Tamil Nadu Private Schools Association honoured about 710 teachers at the teachers' conference 'Right, Respect, Knowledge' organised in association with the YMCA Madras on March 7.

Several teachers, school administrators and educationists from across the State took part in the event organised to commemorate International Women's Day. While 76 principals and administrators were conferred with the 'Global Torch' awards, 41 teachers received the 'Veera Aasiriyar-Vedara-

nyam Suganthi Award-2026'.

Martin Kennedy, School Voice President, expressed gratitude to Chief Minister M.K.Stalin for releasing ₹ 870 crore towards pending Right to Education fee reimbursements to private schools.

Highlighting the resolutions passed during the conference, he said the State government must enact a Teachers and Educational Institutions Protection Act, on the lines of the Tamil Nadu Medicare Service Persons and Medicare Service Institutions (Prevention of Vio-

lence and Damage or Loss to Property) Act.

Noting that only 38 out of 400 Dr. Radhakrishnan Best Teachers Award are allotted to private school teachers, Kennedy said the number of awards must be increased to 800, with 400 awards reserved for private school teachers.

The association's General Secretary M. J. John Arokia Prabhu said the State Council of Educational Research and Training should extend the skill development and incentive training programmes currently being provided to government school teachers to private school teachers as well.

G.Vanitha, Deputy Commissioner of Police (Crime against Women and Children), Parveen, Secretary, Women Lawyers Association, the association's women committee members, including Florence Durairaj, Baggyam Thangaraj, Dorathy Prema, Sugantha Bhai and Soundary Grace also spoke.

THE WORLD IS CHANGING!

Marks and Cramming for Exams
DON'T DETERMINE A CHILD'S FUTURE

Children today need to learn how to ADAPT, CONNECT and USE knowledge & skills in purposeful ways to be successful in any field.



TODDLER COMMUNITY
(14 months - 2.5 years)

PRIMARY CLASSROOM
(2.5 years - 6 years)

LOWER ELEMENTARY
(6 years - 10 years)

Little
PEEPAL
MONTESSORI
SCHOOL



For enquiries call:

+91 97912 16288

AL 204, 14th Main Road, Anna Nagar, Chennai - 40.



Follow us @littlepeepalmontessori

‘Reed’ it right: **bulrushes support avain families**

The Clamorous reed warbler is as loud as they come, but in the urban environment, it is outshouted. Weed clearing at urban habitats in Chennai often brings down its home, the bulrushes. Bulrushes in wetlands are not encroachments, but ‘legal homes’ to birds in the crane and rail family and warblers, so government line agencies ought to tread on them thoughtfully



Across India, the Clamorous reed warbler is common, but its signature clamour gets drowned in urban habitats.
PHOTO: PRINCE FREDERICK

PRINCE FREDERICK

If there is an unabashedly explicit and comprehensively explanatory name under the sun, it is “Clamorous reed warbler”. It encapsulates the species’ social behaviour (trying to shout down everything it encounters within earshot) and habitat preference (reeds, specifically bulrushes). Even its binomial name, *Acrocephalus stentoreus* underlines its boundless capacity for stentorian cries.

In habitats within Chennai limits, its shouting matches might be on a lower key, “foreign powers” making it an unequal contest. Motor vehicles “talk” over the Clamorous reed warbler, the steady hum of running engines drowning its throaty, grating, loud calls. Infrastructure works bring their own din. The Clamorous reed warbler might also find

The crane and rail story

At the slightest suspicion of being noticed, cranes steal away into the bulrushes, the Red-breasted crane more swiftly than the others. The Baillon’s crane could be slightly more tolerant of unwanted attention, but would still stay as close to the reeds as possible while foraging for food. At a reedy patch in Karapakkam right outside a bund of the Pallikaranai Marsh, the Baillon’s crane and the Red-breasted crane would be sighted regularly, and in the nano second in which they would let their guard down, birders would photograph them. That patch has been on a downward course ever since Greater Chen-



The Baillon’s crane needs the ‘safety’ of bulrushes. Photo: Prince Frederick

nai Corporation constructed stormwater drains in the streets leading to it. As part of the SWD construction, massive old concrete pipes were gouged out. Huge boulders which are debris occupy just the section where

its ranks dwindling in urban habitats with loss of reed beds made up of bulrushes. In many parts of the Indian subcontinent, resident populations of the Clamorous reed warbler can be found. In some parts, it is a mix of resident and migratory populations.

If one wants to find the Clamorous reed warbler living up to its name and clamour hard for attention and be heard loud and clear, one has to head to landscapes untouched by development, essentially patches with an overpowering pastoral character. One such patch this writer can recommend lies in Kancheepuram district. To underline how far from Chennai one has to stray to listen to this bird in its unfettered voice at this patch, it is a lake flung around 60 kilometres far away from Chennai’s Pallikaranai marsh, in Kancheepuram district on a link road between

In some instances, bulrushes might have to be sacrificed, but there would also be instances where they could be protected; and they should be protected in those circumstances

Enathur (near the doorway of the temple city Kancheepuram) and Rajakulam (where NH48 has a run). This lake has been christened Sitimabakkam lake by some locals, and others have other names for it. This lake’s buffer zone is pockmarked with patches of water. These patches sport shocks of bulrushes where this bird’s clamour rises to the skies, uninterrupted by ambient sounds. Being found in good numbers at this patch, the Clamorous reed warbler fills the space with its calls, somewhat like a symphony orchestra filling a hall, only that the sounds are grating and raucous.

Beds of bulrushes support waterbirds in the crane and rail family and warblers such as Pallas’s grasshopper warbler and the Clamorous reed warbler.

Urban habitats in Chennai

Returning to Chennai, de-silting and weed removal works in these habitats, particularly carried out in anticipation of the north-east monsoon disturb, unsettle and even obliterate bulrushes. These works are carried out by the Water Resources Department and in instances where lakes are managed by it, Greater Chennai Corporation. Given their mandate and responsibilities, these line agencies would be focussed on ensuring free flow of water, more than anything else. They need to be schooled that everything coming across as weeds need not be weeds; they could be important cogs in the wheel driving ecological balance.

At least in Pallikaranai and Perumbakkam and similar urban habitats that are subject to frequent improvements, the forest department, which has stakes in them, should educate WRD that earth movers need to be wielded with the finesse of a doctor using a scalpel. While removing water hyacinth (which needs to go, considering how they interfere with water flow), care should be taken to retain bulrushes. In some instances, bulrushes might have to be sacrificed, but there would also be instances where they could be protected; and they should be protected in those circumstances.

Award presented to senior optometrist



Ramani Krishnakumar, an eminent optometrist, received the 'Doyen of Indian Optometry: Lifetime Achievement Award in Community Eye Care and Academic Excellence' from TwinTech Healthcare Academy recently. The award, instituted on the occasion

of World Optometry Day (observed annually on March 23), was presented this year at a special event held on March 20 in recognition of Dr. Krishnakumar's three decades of dedicated service in optometry, education, and community eye care, said a release.

Dr Ramani currently serves as president of the Ophthalmic Sciences Professional Council under NCAHP, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India. He has played a pivotal role in strengthening optometric education, advancing professional standards, and mentoring generations of eye care professionals across the country, said the release.

The award was presented by Dr. P. P. Santanam, first principal of Elite School of Optometry and a pioneer in occupational optometry in India, who graced the occasion as chief guest.

A. Mahalingam, managing director, TwinTech Healthcare Academy along with faculty members, optometrists, and distinguished guests, participated in the event.

A proud day for these tiny tots



Olive Tree Global School in Madhavaram celebrated UKG Graduation Day with great enthusiasm and pride as the young learners successfully completed their senior kindergarten.

During the ceremony, the little graduates looked adorable in their graduation attire as they proudly received their Senior Kindergarten Diploma certificates, says a press release. The certificates were awarded in recognition of the children's sincere efforts, consistent progress and outstanding achievements throughout the academ-

ic year. Teachers and school leaders congratulated the children for their dedication and encouraged them to continue learning with the same enthusiasm. The event also acknowledged the support and encouragement of parents and teachers who played a vital role in nurturing the children's talent and confidence, the release says.

The graduation ceremony was filled with happy smiles, proud moments, and memorable photographs, making it a special day for the children and their families, it adds.

Army personnel felicitated



Thirty Indian Army personnels from various cadres were felicitated at a function organised by Deepika BUILTECH, a Chennai-based civil engineering services in Ambattur. The event was organised as part of the company's fifth anniversary celebration.

The function started with patriotic songs. B. Sabapathi, CEO and S. Latha, managing director of the Deepika BUILTECH, felicitated the special guests.

According to a press release, the personnels included Colonel P. Ganesan, VSM (Retd.); Major Madhan Kumar (Retd.); Subedar Dr. V. Yasudevan (Retd.); Subedar Dr. Vinayaga Moorthy (Retd.); Havildar A. Jayamurugan (Retd.); Havildar P. S. Ananthanarayanan (Retd.) - EME; Havildar C. Vadivel (Retd.); Naik Ganapathy Subramanian

(Retd.); Naik R. Sakthivel (Retd.); Lance Naik M. Prabakaran - NSG, Indian Army; Honorary Captain A. Chandrasekaran (Retd.) - EME; Honorary Captain Thirumal (Retd.); Honorary Captain G. Selvaraj (Retd.); Honorary Subedar Major K. Muthu Kumar (Retd.); Air Vice Marshal Krishnaswamy Sridharan, VM (Retd.); Wing Commander K. R. Srikanth (Retd.); Junior Warrant Officer Dhasarathan Murthy (Retd.); Sergeant D. Krishnamoorthy (Retd.); Sergeant Suresh Babu R. (Retd.); Sergeant Mani (Retd.); Sergeant Ruklesh Nair (Retd.); Corporal Nithyanandan (Retd.); Air-craftsman Srinivasa Subramanian (Retd.); Additional Director General K. R. Suresh (Retd.); Pradhan Adhikari N. Bharathan (Retd.); and Lieutenant Commander D. Kuzhali Vidhya (Retd.)

Annual day at MCC Public School

This year's annual day at MCC Public School in Chetpet was celebrated on two days.

The pre-primary celebration, themed "Once Upon a Time," transformed the auditorium into a magical fairy-tale world. The little ones, dressed as charming storybook characters, performed delightful dances and short skits that radiated innocence and joy.

A few days later, the seniors celebrated "Retro Revival" with electrifying dances to popular Hindi, Tamil and English songs from the 70s, 80s and 90s.

Best Bargains

SIVAN TRADER E-WASTE

AC 1 டன் 1.5 டன் 2 டன்
₹3500 ₹5000 ₹6500

- Stainless Steel 1Kg ₹50
- Aluminium 1Kg ₹160
- Brass 1Kg ₹550
- Copper 1Kg ₹900
- Water Heater
- Home Theatre
- Music System

INVERTER BATTERIES Any Condition

₹3500/-

Call: 97108 20853

ECR LAND SALE

NEMMELI VILLAGE VACANT LAND
3200 SQFT, BACKWATER VIEW,
OPP INTERCONTINENTAL HOTEL.
NEAR CROC PARK & THIRUPORUR
WEST & EAST(OPT) FACING ROAD.
PRICE Rs78L. BROKERS EXCUSE.

CLEAR TITLE, SIZE 80 x 40ft
CAN MOVE IMMEDIATE OR INVEST

9500060641

PRINTZ CARE
Exclusive Shop For Retting & Printer Service

PRINTER SERVICE
INKJET & TONER REFILLING

ON SPOT DOOR STEP SERVICE

98946 55595

SOFA SERVICE

ANY SOFA'S RECLINER SOFAS CUSHIONS REUPHOLSTERY

Reconditioning @ Very Moderate Charges

K.N.S.RAJAN SERVICES
76671 33233
93818 03956

CONSTRUCTION

- Material & Labour Contract
- Interior works
- Renovation
- Roof Gardening

98400 42265
98415 58184

LIC JEEVAN UMANG

- Best Plan
- Pay Rs. 1 Lac for 15 Years (with IT Rebate)
- Get Rs. 1 Lac from 16th year Every year upto Age 100
- In 100th year?

GET Rs. 1 CRORE, 20 LAKHS+ ALL TAX FREE TAX FREE

To Get It.... Call.... 31.3.2026 Last Date
S. RAMESH
93810 44548

Works of four women artists

Thooriga, a collective of four women artists, is having its seventh art exhibition till March 23 at Kalpa Druma, Cathedral Road, Gopalapuram.

Each exhibition of Thooriga celebrates Tamil Nadu's rich cultural heritage, the beauty of nature, and the strength and grace of women in art.

The show will feature artworks by Gayathri Balaji, Yamuna Bala, Sathya N. Prabhu, and Charanya Rajesh. They explore themes that connect tradition, spirituality, storytelling, and the inner strength of human experience.

To advertise in
DOWNTOWN

Contact:
SATHIAMORTHY
70927 03458

In campaign mode



Party flags and other election campaign materials are on sale ahead of the Assembly Election 2026 at Parrys Corner. PHOTO: R. RAGU

Adapted volleyball tournament in Meenambakkam

Lit The Light Trust is conducting Louis Braille Trophy 2026, a state-level adapted volleyball tournament for the visually challenged, on March 29 at Indoor Stadium, Agurchand Manmull Jain College, Meenambakkam; 8 a.m. onwards.

The event is aimed at promoting inclusive sports and empowering visually challenged athletes. This is the second edition of the tournament and at least 13 teams from across the State are expected to take part.

For details, call 98949 49878

Spot the planets today



Science and Nature Club of Periyar Nagar, is organising 'We shall measure the sky', a naked eye astronomy event on March 22 at 6.30 p.m.

Duraiswamy Navaneetham, who holds a doctorate in molecular biology, will take participants on a stargazing journey. They will be guided to locate Venus, Jupiter, stars and stellar constellations.

Entry is free. Interested people may call 9962565743. Details of the venue will be shared through WhatsApp.

Workshop on wedding photography

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute, a Department of MSME - Tamil Nadu is conducting a training programme on wedding photography and video editing from March 23 to 27. For details, call 8668102600/8754495254.

Making incense sticks

The institute is also conducting another workshop on making incense sticks, camphor, and candles from March 24 to 26. The session will

also focus on making rose water and detergents meant for cleaning brass and silver articles.

Both liquid and power detergents will be taught, says a press release. For details, call 9360221280 / 98401 14680.

Both the workshops will be held at the institute's premises at EDII Office Road, Ekkattuthangal. Time: From 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. Prior registration is mandatory. Those 18 years of age and above can take part.

LEARN TO SWIM

SUMMER CAMP

"Learn and Practice Swimming at young age and lead a healthy Life for Ever"

DOLPHIN SWIMMING ACADEMY

STARTING ON 24TH MARCH ONWARDS

CLASSES CONDUCTED PROFESSIONALLY

94449 06878 / 94449 55878

79027 08095 / 93450 04088

044-2653 4211

CLASSES FREE FOR UNDERPRIVILEGED STUDENTS

பாஸ்போர்ட் சர்வீஸ் **PASSPORT SERVICES**

வைகை விங்ஸ் **Vaigai Wings**

The Dependable Travel Service

Crescent Court, 963 Periyar EVR High Road, Chennai - 600 084, India

Tel: +91 7338791804 | +91 6384552233 | +91-44-26413126

Email: welcome@vaigai.com | Website: https://www.vaigai.com

DCF Durable Chrome Factory

On Ladies & Gents Footwear

SALE UPTO 30%

@ ANNA NAGAR

No 336/4, Sunshine Apartment, Anna Nagar, Chennai - 600040

PH: 70108 00625

ஜி.எஸ்.டி. இல்லா LIFE, HEALTH, PERSONAL ACCIDENT & TRAVEL INSURANCE

Get Professional Guidance & Service from an exp. Senior Insurance Advisor (+24 yrs) & Mutual Fund Distributor (+18 yrs)

To Start SIP/SWP - Click: <https://p.njw.bz/54597>

இனிய தமிழில்

MF / SIP / SWP -ஐ

பற்றி அறிந்து புரிந்து துவக்க, உடனே தொடர்பு செய்க



S.RAMALINGAM

NISM, LUTC Fellow, RVCC / IRDA Cert. Insurance Advisor, AMFI Cert. MFD (ARN-55553)

Mob: 98401-47301 / 98844-95696



"Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks. Read all scheme related documents carefully."

GAYATHRI PHARMACY

GET YOUR BRANDED MEDICINE AT YOUR DOORSTEP

ALL MEDICINES 20% DISCOUNT
(For Medicines Purchase Above Rs.1,000)

HOME DELIVERY AVAILABLE All Over Chennai

7845998336, 93611 46912, 044 3594 7644